

explain http method with respect to idempotent

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- All
- Videos
- Images
- Shopping
- Short videos
- Forums
- More
- Tools

AI Overview

हिन्दी

Idempotency in HTTP methods means that **multiple identical requests have the same intended effect on the server as a single request, even if the response status codes might differ**. This property is crucial for building fault-tolerant APIs, allowing clients to safely retry requests in case of network errors or timeouts. [Stack Overflow +2](#)

Idempotent vs. Non-Idempotent Methods

The HTTP specification defines certain methods as idempotent and others as non-idempotent. [Java Code Geeks](#)

Method	Idempotent	Description
GET	Yes	Retrieves data. Repeated calls do not change the server's state, only read it.
HEAD	Yes	Similar to GET, retrieves only headers. Does not affect server state.
OPTIONS	Yes	Describes communication options for a resource. No server state change.
TRACE	Yes	Performs a message loop-back test for diagnostic purposes. No server state change.
PUT	Yes	Replaces the <i>entire</i> resource at a specific URI. Repeatedly sending the same full representation leaves the resource in the same final state.
DELETE	Yes	Removes a resource. After the first successful deletion, subsequent identical requests still result in the resource being gone (the same final state), though they might return a <code>404 Not Found</code> or <code>204 No Content</code> status code.
POST	No	Typically used to <i>create</i> new resources. Each identical request can result in the creation of a new, distinct resource (e.g., multiple identical